

CSS Selectors Cheat-Sheet

A quick reference with syntax, mini-example & plain-English.

Element Selector

Syntax:

```
element {  
  /* CSS properties */  
}
```

Example:

```
h1 {  
  color: purple;  
  font-size: 24px;  
}
```

What it does: Applies to <h1> tags everywhere on the page.

ID Selector (#)

Syntax:

```
#myID {  
  /* CSS properties */  
}
```

Example:

```
#header {  
  background-color: teal;  
  padding: 10px;  
}
```

What it does: Targets the single element with id="header".

Class Selector (.)

Syntax:

```
.myClass {  
  /* CSS properties */  
}
```

Example:

```
.card {  
  border: 1px solid #ddd;  
  border-radius: 4px;  
}
```

```
padding: 8px;  
}
```

What it does: Styles every element with `class="card"`.

Attribute Selector

Syntax:

```
[attribute] { ... }  
[attribute=value] { ... }
```

Example:

```
input[type="text"] {  
  border: 1px solid #aaa;  
}
```

What it does: Styles all `<input>` elements whose `type` is exactly "text".

Descendant Selector

Syntax:

```
parent descendant { ... }
```

Example:

```
nav a {  
  color: darkblue;  
}
```

What it does: Styles all `<a>` tags inside any `<nav>`.

Child Selector ()

Syntax:

```
parent > child { ... }
```

Example:

```
ul > li {  
  list-style: square;  
}
```

What it does: Styles only the `<li>` elements that are direct children of `<ul>`.

Adjacent Sibling Selector (+)

Syntax:

```
element1 + element2 { ... }
```

Example:

```
h2 + p {  
  margin-top: 0;  
}
```

What it does: Styles the very next `<p>` immediately following each `<h2>`.

General Sibling Selector ()

Syntax:

```
element1 ~ element2 { ... }
```

Example:

```
h2 ~ p {  
  color: gray;  
}
```

What it does: Styles every `<p>` that comes after an `<h2>`, not just the first.

Pseudo-class Selectors

Syntax:

```
selector:pseudo-class { ... }
```

Example:

```
a:hover {  
  text-decoration: underline;  
}
```

What it does: Applies when the user hovers over any link.

Pseudo-element Selectors

Syntax:

```
selector::pseudo-element { ... }
```

Example:

```
p::first-line {  
  font-weight: bold;  
}
```

What it does: Styles only the very first line of each paragraph.

Universal Selector (*)

Syntax:

```
* { /* CSS properties */ }
```

Example:

```
* {  
  box-sizing: border-box;  
}
```

What it does: Applies box-sizing to every single element.